Kaylena D. Pham

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Education

University of Southern California – *Los Angeles, CA* Expected May 2027
B.S. in Geological Sciences | **Major GPA:** 3.95
Awards and Honors: Presidential Scholar, USC Lambda LGBTQ+ Scholar, Women in Mining Scholar
Relevant Coursework: Climate Dynamics, Data Analysis in Earth & Environmental Sciences, Geochemistry

Skills

Geospatial and Engineering Software: ArcGIS, AutoCAD, SolidWorks
Programming Language: Python, Java, Java Script, C++, R, HTML
Technical: Data Visualization, Statistical Analysis, Scientific Writing, Project Management

Professional Experience

Significant Opportunities in Atmospheric Research and Science Research Intern May – August 2026
NSF National Center for Atmospheric Research (NCAR) *– Boulder, CO*

- Independently characterized performance of low-cost PM2.5 sensors across multiple U.S. field deployments
- Developed Python workflows to evaluate sensor accuracy and comparisons against reference-grade instrumentation
- Authored a full-length research paper and presented findings at poster and oral presentation, developing science communication skills to convey complex calibration methodology to diverse technical and public audiences

Student Airborne Research Program Intern (SARP) June – August 2025
National Aeronautics and Space Program (NASA) *– Richmond, VA*

- Investigated methane emissions from East Coast wetlands by integrating MODIS NDVI satellite imagery with in-situ methane measurements from NASA SARP flight campaigns
- Produced high-resolution geospatial visualizations in Python and ArcGIS to analyze vegetation stress and emission patterns across temporal and ecological gradients
- Conducted comparative analyses between multiple field sites, incorporating variables such as soil moisture and canopy cover

Undergraduate Researcher September 2023 – Present
Atmospheric Composition and Earth Data Science Lab *– Los Angeles, CA*

- Studied physiological resilience of saguaro cacti to elevated ozone levels by analyzing stomatal conductance and resistance data under experimental exposure
- Processed and visualized time-series atmospheric ozone and plant physiological data using Python and Pandas to identify trends and anomalies in gas exchange behaviors

Extracurriculars

President September 2024 – Current
Queers In Engineering, Science, and Technology (QuEST)

- Lead corporate outreach and partnership development, securing sponsorships, coordinating professional networking events, and fostering relationships with alumni organizations
- Partnered with university career services to co-host career panels and technical workshops for LGBTQ+ students in STEM with 50–100+ attendees to provide members an expansive professional network
- Directing a leadership team of eight and managing club programming, budgeting, and member engagement

Crochet Artist March 2025 – Current
USC Cats

- Spearheaded a creative initiative by placing crocheted “hidden cats” around campus, enhancing student experience while managing social media engagement